NYC Policy Implementation Observatory

Executive brief

Study: October 2025–September 2026. Seasonal baseline: October 2024–September 2025. Prepared 28 October 2026.

What the available evidence shows

The validated NYC 311 extract contains 3,595,690 baseline requests and 3,963,901 study-period requests, an increase of 10.2%. The weighted share of mature requests with an administrative closure recorded within 30 days moved from 91.0% to 90.4%, a decline of 0.65 percentage points. Unresolved-as-of-cutoff records increased by 83,031. These measures describe reported demand and administrative processing; they do not prove unmet need, service resolution or agency effectiveness.

Request volume increased in every named borough. The 30-day closure rate declined by 1.80 percentage points in the Bronx and 1.19 points in Brooklyn, changed little in Queens, and increased slightly in Manhattan and Staten Island. Fifty comparable agency-service-community-district combinations were retained for investigation, each with at least 30 mature requests in both periods. Several DOB boiler cells show large declines, but classification or workflow changes must be checked before interpreting them as operational deterioration.

What cannot yet be answered

RQ1 cannot be answered comprehensively. The accessible Council Open Data asset ends on 27 February 2025, before the study year, and automated Mayor/agency publication retrieval is blocked. No complete source-verified study-year policy registry or implementation evidence set is available. The observatory therefore reports these as missing evidence and does not infer implementation from announcements, topical similarity or later 311 changes.

Socioeconomic context is also incomplete. Community-district population, poverty and income denominators have not been accepted into the production model. Current results compare service records across administrative geographies and must not be described as a full socioeconomic equity assessment.

Three dashboard pages

Neighborhood Equity will show baseline/study totals, monthly trends and borough comparisons. **Operational Priorities** will provide the 50-row investigation queue with agency, service, district, volume and closure-rate change. **Policy Responsiveness** will expose verified policy evidence when available and currently shows explicit coverage gaps, preventing an incomplete registry from appearing complete.

Controls on interpretation

Rates are recomputed from summed numerators and denominators. Both periods use seasonally matched months and comparable 30-day maturity. Small cells are excluded from the investigation queue. Median and percentile durations are not averaged across cells. No causal effect, significance test, agency ranking or risk probability is supplied.

Release sequence

The complete 311 data, analysis tables and Cube semantic models are deployed to Neon/Cube. The next release step is native Cube Dashboard authoring and visual reconciliation against the independent totals. Policy and socioeconomic extensions will be added only when official coverage and geography are verified; they do not block publication of the qualified RQ2 dashboard.